

FAQ Repository

The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment

by Ravi V. Melwani

10 Topics · 15 Questions & Answers per Topic · 150 Total FAQs

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TOPIC 1: FREEDOM

Commandment 1 — "Thou Shall Be Free"

Q1: What does freedom really mean according to this book?

A: Freedom isn't about money or independence in the worldly sense; it's an inner state where nothing -- people, possessions, or outcomes -- has a grip on you. You can enjoy life fully without needing any of it to feel whole.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 1 – "Thou Shall Be Free", Page 17

Q2: Why do my possessions make me feel trapped instead of happy?

A: When we grow attached to what we own, we unconsciously hand over our peace of mind to those objects. We start guarding, worrying about, and depending on them, and in doing so we become controlled by the very things we thought we controlled.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 1 – "Thou Shall Be Free", Page 18

Q3: Is it wrong to enjoy relationships if I want to be free?

A: Not at all. The book distinguishes between loving someone and being bound by them. You can deeply enjoy a relationship while giving the other person, and yourself, the freedom to be authentic, rather than gripping each other out of fear or insecurity.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 1 – "Thou Shall Be Free", Page 19

Q4: Why do attachments create stress and anxiety?

A: Every attachment is really a hidden expectation that something or someone must stay a certain way. Since nothing in life is permanent, this constant need for things to remain unchanged generates ongoing tension and worry.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 1 – "Thou Shall Be Free", Page 20

Q5: How can I let go of attachment to things I worked hard for?

A: The book points out that we arrive empty-handed and leave empty-handed; nothing accompanies us through life's journey. Recognizing this truth softens our grip, letting us enjoy our achievements without being owned by them.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 1 – "Thou Shall Be Free", Page 21

Q6: Don't loving relationships require some attachment?

A: Love itself doesn't require attachment; in fact, the healthiest relationships are the ones where both people grant each other the freedom to grow and choose, rather than clinging out of need or fear of loss.

Q7: What happens when a relationship becomes more about control than love?

A: When attachment overtakes love, the relationship turns from a source of joy into a source of suffocation. People begin restricting one another's choices, which slowly drains the very joy the relationship was meant to provide.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 1 – "Thou Shall Be Free", Page 23

Q8: Why do attachments cause us to give up the things we love?

A: Attachment narrows our world. To protect what we cling to, we often restrict our own choices and freedoms, ending up living a smaller, more constrained life than the one we actually want.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 1 – "Thou Shall Be Free", Page 24

Q9: Why do human beings get so attached to things that aren't permanent?

A: We live with the illusion that what we have -- homes, relationships, status -- will last forever. This ignorance about impermanence is what fuels our attachment in the first place.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 1 – "Thou Shall Be Free", Page 25

Q10: What is the ultimate goal of life according to this teaching?

A: The book describes the ultimate goal as liberation, or moving beyond the endless cycle of craving and attachment toward lasting inner freedom and union with the Divine, rather than the accumulation of wealth or status.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 1 – "Thou Shall Be Free", Page 26

Q11: How does living detached help me reach that ultimate goal?

A: Those who practice detached attachment progressively loosen the grip that worldly things hold over them, which the book frames as the path that moves a person closer to true liberation.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 1 – "Thou Shall Be Free", Page 27

Q12: Can I still pursue success and ambition while staying detached?

A: Yes. The book uses the metaphor of living like a free 'boss' rather than a bound 'horse' -- you can pursue goals and enjoy success, as long as you aren't enslaved by the need for that success.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 1 – "Thou Shall Be Free", Page 28

Q13: Why is freedom called 'the first Commandment'?

A: Freedom is positioned first because it's the foundation everything else rests on. Without an inner resolve to stay unbound, the remaining teachings about happiness, love, and peace become much harder to practice.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 1 – "Thou Shall Be Free", Page 17

Q14: How do I start practicing detachment in daily life?

A: The book frames it as a conscious choice you renew constantly: noticing when you are gripping onto an outcome, a person, or a possession, and gently reminding yourself that lasting peace doesn't depend on holding tight to it.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 1 – "Thou Shall Be Free", Page 20

Q15: What's the difference between detachment and not caring?

A: Detachment isn't indifference. You can care deeply and engage fully with life and relationships; what changes is your inner dependency on a particular result. You act and love wholeheartedly, while releasing the need to control the outcome.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 1 – "Thou Shall Be Free", Page 22

TOPIC 2: HAPPINESS

Commandment 2 — "Thou Shall Be Happy"

Q1: Is happiness just about chasing pleasure?

A: No. The book draws a clear line between fleeting pleasure, which comes and goes with circumstance, and genuine happiness, which is described as a deliberate, ongoing choice rather than a reaction to outside events.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 2 – "Thou Shall Be Happy", Page 29

Q2: How can I be happy 'in the now' instead of waiting for the future?

A: Living happily in the present means closing the door on yesterday's regrets and tomorrow's worries, choosing instead to fully inhabit today rather than postponing joy for some future achievement.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 2 – "Thou Shall Be Happy", Page 30

Q3: Why do achievements not make me as happy as I expect?

A: Once the initial excitement of an achievement fades, the underlying patterns of the mind reassert themselves. The book argues that chasing success or wealth for happiness is a cycle that never permanently satisfies, since the goalposts keep moving.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 2 – "Thou Shall Be Happy", Page 31

Q4: Are wealthy or successful people automatically happier?

A: The book observes that many people with significant wealth and achievement are not happy, which is offered as evidence that happiness doesn't come from external accumulation but from an internal state.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 2 – "Thou Shall Be Happy", Page 32

Q5: What does it mean that happiness is 'a state of being'?

A: Rather than something you have to manufacture through effort or acquisition, happiness is described as something you already are at your core; you simply have to stop letting the mind's noise obscure it.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 2 – "Thou Shall Be Happy", Page 33

Q6: Why do I keep seeking something just out of reach, like the musk deer?

A: The book uses the musk deer, which roams searching for a fragrance that's actually coming from within itself, as an image for our own habit of looking outward for a joy that's already present inside us.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 2 – "Thou Shall Be Happy", Page 34

Q7: What is the 'Happiness Paradox'?

A: It's the irony that when happiness becomes an anxious, urgent pursuit, the very striving for it creates stress and dissatisfaction, undermining the goal. Real happiness arrives more easily when it isn't desperately chased.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 2 – "Thou Shall Be Happy", Page 35

Q8: How should I deal with things I cannot control, like circumstances?

A: Since none of us can control everything happening around us, including our own birth and death, the book suggests we stop letting uncontrollable circumstances dictate our inner state and choose contentment regardless.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 2 – "Thou Shall Be Happy", Page 36

Q9: Why did the man in the story get so upset over a scratched car?

A: His extreme attachment to a possession meant that a minor scratch felt like a major loss. The story illustrates how attachment magnifies small setbacks into significant sources of misery.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 2 – "Thou Shall Be Happy", Page 37

Q10: Who is really stealing my peace and happiness?

A: The book points to our own untrained mind as the real thief, since it's our reactive thoughts and attachments, not external events themselves, that rob us of contentment.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 2 – "Thou Shall Be Happy", Page 38

Q11: Can happiness be a daily choice rather than a mood?

A: Yes, the book frames happiness as a vow or resolve, something actively chosen each day, rather than something that simply happens to you depending on luck or circumstance.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 2 – "Thou Shall Be Happy", Page 29

Q12: Why do I feel like I'm on an emotional rollercoaster, happy one moment and low the next?

A: This happens when happiness is treated as something to 'become' through external wins rather than something you already are; that approach keeps you oscillating with circumstances instead of resting in stable contentment.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 2 – "Thou Shall Be Happy", Page 33

Q13: What's the difference between contentment and complacency?

A: Contentment is an inner peace that doesn't depend on getting more, while complacency implies giving up effort altogether. The book's teaching is about finding peace within while still engaging fully with life and its goals.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 2 – "Thou Shall Be Happy", Page 31

Q14: How does this Commandment relate to detachment from outcomes?

A: Choosing happiness as a state of being, rather than as a reward for outcomes, naturally reduces our dependence on specific results, which is the essence of the detachment this book teaches throughout.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 2 – "Thou Shall Be Happy", Page 35

Q15: Can I be happy even during difficult or painful times?

A: The teaching suggests that happiness as an inner resolve can coexist with difficulty, since it isn't dependent on circumstances being favorable; it's a choice you renew regardless of what's happening around you.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 2 – "Thou Shall Be Happy", Page 30

TOPIC 3: LOVE

Commandment 3 — "Thou Shall Love All"

Q1: What does it mean to 'love all' instead of just one person?

A: The teaching encourages expanding love beyond a single romantic attachment to a broader, more universal love -- one that flows freely toward others rather than being narrowly possessive of just one relationship.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 3 – "Thou Shall Love All", Page 39

Q2: How is detached love different from attached love?

A: Attached love clings and seeks to possess the other person, often leading to jealousy and pain. Detached love, by contrast, allows the other person freedom and choice while still being deeply caring and committed.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 3 – "Thou Shall Love All", Page 40

Q3: What is meant by love coming 'from the Soul' rather than 'skin to skin'?

A: The book distinguishes superficial, body-based attraction from a deeper, soulful connection. True love is described as transcending the physical and emotional surface, connecting at a deeper, more enduring level.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 3 – "Thou Shall Love All", Page 41

Q4: What are the different 'colours of love' described in the book?

A: The book uses a spectrum metaphor, comparing different qualities of love -- such as innocent romantic love versus deeper, selfless love -- to colours of light, with the purest form likened to pure white, Divine love.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 3 – "Thou Shall Love All", Page 42

Q5: Why does romantic love sometimes lead to suffering?

A: When romantic love is rooted purely in physical attraction or possessiveness, it inevitably runs into disappointment, jealousy, or heartbreak, since it depends on the other person matching our expectations.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 3 – "Thou Shall Love All", Page 43

Q6: How can I love someone without being attached to them?

A: It involves caring for and committing to someone while accepting that you can't possess or control them entirely. You love their wellbeing and freedom as much as you love being with them.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 3 – "Thou Shall Love All", Page 44

Q7: Is Divine love different from human love?

A: Divine love is described as unconditional and selfless, free from the neediness and expectation that often colour ordinary human relationships, making it more stable and enduring.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 3 – "Thou Shall Love All", Page 45

Q8: What did the ancient Greeks and Sufis teach about love?

A: The book references how these traditions classified love into multiple types, including romantic or erotic love, to show that love has many dimensions beyond the purely physical or possessive kind most people default to.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 3 – "Thou Shall Love All", Page 46

Q9: Why does attachment to a romantic partner make us miserable?

A: Becoming consumed by erotic or possessive love ties our happiness entirely to another person's behaviour and presence, which the book argues cannot deliver the lasting happiness we're really seeking.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 3 – "Thou Shall Love All", Page 47

Q10: What lesson does Susan's story teach about love and attachment?

A: Susan's story, about being torn between her marriage and a deeper longing, illustrates how attachment to romantic passion can create internal conflict, and points toward seeking the deeper, soulful love that the book recommends.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 3 – "Thou Shall Love All", Page 48

Q11: Can I love my family and friends without controlling them?

A: Yes, the book's vision of detached love applies to all relationships, encouraging us to support loved ones generously while letting go of the urge to dictate their choices or outcomes.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 3 – "Thou Shall Love All", Page 40

Q12: How does loving 'all' change the way I treat strangers?

A: Expanding love beyond your inner circle means extending kindness, compassion, and goodwill more broadly, recognizing a shared Divine essence in everyone rather than reserving love only for those closest to you.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 3 – "Thou Shall Love All", Page 39

Q13: Why is jealousy so common in romantic relationships?

A: Jealousy arises from attachment and the fear of losing possession of the other person. The book frames this as a symptom of attached love rather than something inherent to love itself.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 3 – "Thou Shall Love All", Page 43

Q14: What practical step can I take to love more selflessly?

A: The book suggests shifting focus from what you get out of a relationship to genuinely wanting the other person's happiness and freedom, even when that doesn't serve your own attachment or expectations.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 3 – "Thou Shall Love All", Page 44

Q15: How does this Commandment connect to inner peace?

A: Loving without possessiveness removes a major source of emotional turbulence -- jealousy, control, and fear of loss -- making it easier to maintain the peace of mind the book emphasizes throughout.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 3 – "Thou Shall Love All", Page 45

TOPIC 4: EXPECTATIONS

Commandment 4 — "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations"

Q1: Why do expectations lead to unhappiness?

A: Expectations set a fixed picture of how people or situations should turn out. When reality doesn't match that picture, which it often doesn't, disappointment and frustration follow.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 4 – "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations", Page 49

Q2: Is it realistic to live with absolutely no expectations?

A: The book frames this as an ongoing practice of detached attachment rather than a one-time switch; you work toward releasing rigid expectations of others while still engaging actively in relationships and goals.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 4 – "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations", Page 50

Q3: How do I give people their freedom without expecting anything back?

A: It means allowing others the space to make their own choices, even when those choices don't match what you hoped for, recognizing that demanding specific behaviour from someone curtails their freedom and your own peace.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 4 – "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations", Page 51

Q4: What is the Law of Karma and how does it relate to expectations?

A: The book describes karma as the law of action and reaction, where outcomes unfold according to causes already set in motion. Understanding this can reduce the urge to expect specific results, since events are unfolding through a larger causal order.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 4 – "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations", Page 52

Q5: Why do unmet expectations cause heartbreak?

A: When we emotionally invest in a specific outcome from another person and that outcome doesn't materialize, the gap between hope and reality creates the pain we call heartbreak.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 4 – "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations", Page 53

Q6: Is love just an 'ordinary barter' of give and take?

A: The book challenges this transactional view, suggesting that reducing love to a fair exchange -- expecting equal return for what you give -- misses the deeper, freer nature that genuine love is meant to have.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 4 – "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations", Page 54

Q7: How does realizing we are the Soul help reduce expectations?

A: Recognizing that we are not merely the body but a Divine Soul who arrives and departs without bringing or taking anything material helps loosen our grip on outcomes and expectations tied to worldly relationships.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 4 – "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations", Page 55

Q8: What does Raj's story about searching hospitals teach about expectation and attachment?

A: Raj's frantic search illustrates how deeply attachment and expectation can consume us emotionally when someone we love is at risk, highlighting just how much suffering unmanaged attachment can produce.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 4 – "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations", Page 56

Q9: Can I have goals without having expectations?

A: Yes -- the book's teaching is less about abandoning ambition and more about not tying your peace of mind to a specific, demanded outcome. You can work toward goals while accepting that life may unfold differently.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 4 – "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations", Page 50

Q10: Why do we expect people to behave the way we want?

A: This often comes from attachment -- we want our relationships to feel secure and predictable, so we unconsciously impose expectations on others to control that uncertainty.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 4 – "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations", Page 51

Q11: How can understanding karma bring peace when things don't go my way?

A: If you trust that outcomes are unfolding according to a larger causal order rather than randomly or unfairly, it becomes easier to accept results without resentment or excessive expectation.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 4 – "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations", Page 52

Q12: What's the connection between expectations and disappointment in relationships?

A: Most relationship disappointment traces back to an expectation that wasn't communicated or wasn't realistic. Lowering rigid expectations reduces the frequency and intensity of these disappointments.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 4 – "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations", Page 53

Q13: Does releasing expectations mean I stop caring about outcomes?

A: No, it means caring about the process and your own effort while releasing the demand that the outcome must go exactly as you envisioned.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 4 – "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations", Page 49

Q14: How do expectations affect my relationship with money and possessions?

A: Expecting wealth or possessions to deliver lasting satisfaction sets up the same disappointment pattern as expecting too much from people, since material things can't fulfill an expectation built for permanent happiness.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 4 – "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations", Page 54

Q15: What is one practical way to reduce expectations day to day?

A: The book's underlying suggestion is to notice when you're demanding a specific result from a person or situation, and consciously soften that demand into a preference, staying open to other outcomes.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 4 – "Thou Shall Not Have Expectations", Page 55

TOPIC 5: PEACE OF MIND

Commandment 5 — "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind"

Q1: What is actually stealing my peace of mind?

A: The book identifies the restless mind itself as the main culprit -- its constant stream of thoughts about the past and future is what disturbs the inner stillness that peace requires.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 5 – "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind", Page 57

Q2: Why does the mind create fear, worry, and anxiety?

A: The mind habitually drags us into regret and shame by replaying the past, and into stress and worry by projecting fears about the future, rarely letting us rest in the present.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 5 – "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind", Page 58

Q3: What myths does the mind make us believe?

A: Among other things, the mind convinces us that things are permanent and that we will be here forever, when in reality, change and impermanence are constants of life.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 5 – "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind", Page 59

Q4: What is mindfulness according to this book?

A: Mindfulness is described as a state of emptying the mind of its constant chatter, becoming thoughtless like a still lake without ripples, rather than the popular notion of simply paying close attention.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 5 – "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind", Page 60

Q5: Is the mind the same thing as the brain?

A: No. The book draws an analogy where the brain is the hardware and the mind is comparable to software running on it, distinguishing the physical organ from the mental patterns and thoughts it produces.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 5 – "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind", Page 61

Q6: What is the difference between the mind and the intellect?

A: The book positions the intellect as the higher controller of our life and decisions, while the mind operates more like an unreliable operating system prone to illusions and toxic thought patterns.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 5 – "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind", Page 62

Q7: Why does the mind convince us that this world is permanent?

A: The mind operates on the illusion of permanence because acknowledging impermanence would force us to confront uncomfortable truths about loss and mortality, which it would rather avoid.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 5 – "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind", Page 63

Q8: Why does intense love for someone sometimes turn into unhappiness?

A: When attachment to a loved one becomes overwhelming, the joy it should bring gets overshadowed by anxiety about losing them, turning what the book calls a fountain of joy into emotional turbulence.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 5 – "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind", Page 64

Q9: How do addictions destroy peace of mind?

A: Addiction is described as a state where we lose sight of everything else because of fixation on one craving, and that fixation becomes a constant disturbance to inner peace.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 5 – "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind", Page 65

Q10: What does the story of the businessman on holiday teach about peace of mind?

A: The businessman's peace was disrupted by a phone call about a problem at work, showing how easily the 'rascal mind' can hijack our calm even during moments meant for relaxation.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 5 – "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind", Page 66

Q11: How can I tell if my mind is robbing my peace right now?

A: If you notice persistent worry about the future or rumination about the past disrupting your present moment, the book would identify that as the mind's typical activity stealing your peace.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 5 – "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind", Page 58

Q12: Can peace of mind coexist with an active, busy life?

A: Yes -- the book's vision of peace is an inner stillness beneath activity, not the absence of action; you can be busy and engaged while remaining undisturbed inside.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 5 – "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind", Page 60

Q13: Why is stilling the mind described as a path to lasting peace?

A: Since the mind's chatter is identified as the primary disruptor of peace, quieting that chatter directly removes the obstacle, allowing the naturally peaceful state underneath to surface.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 5 – "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind", Page 60

Q14: How does attachment relate to losing peace of mind?

A: Attachment fuels much of the mind's anxious thinking, since we worry about losing what we're attached to; reducing attachment, therefore, reduces a major source of mental disturbance.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 5 – "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind", Page 64

Q15: What practical step helps quiet a restless mind?

A: The book points toward practices like mindfulness or meditation that create gaps in the mind's chatter, gradually training it to rest rather than constantly churn through thoughts.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 5 – "Thou Shall Not Lose Peace of Mind", Page 60

TOPIC 6: ACCEPTANCE AND SURRENDER

Commandment 6 — "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender"

Q1: What is the difference between accepting and surrendering?

A: Acceptance means acknowledging life and people as they actually are, rather than as we wish them to be, while surrender means releasing our need to control or wonder why things happen the way they do.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 6 – "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender", Page 67

Q2: Can I really control how other people behave?

A: The book argues no -- we cannot control other people's actions, only our own responses, and trying to control others is a losing battle that only adds to our suffering.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 6 – "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender", Page 69

Q3: Why do we waste energy wondering why people do what they do?

A: Wondering and hoping that others will act differently keeps us tied to outcomes we can't influence, when accepting their choices, even when we disagree, frees up that mental energy.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 6 – "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender", Page 70

Q4: Should I just let people make bad choices without saying anything?

A: The book suggests we can voice our perspective, but ultimately we should respect others' right to choose their own path, supporting them even when we'd choose differently ourselves.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 6 – "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender", Page 71

Q5: What is the Law of Karma's role in acceptance?

A: Understanding that life unfolds according to the law of action and reaction helps us accept events as part of a larger causal order rather than as random injustices we must resist or control.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 6 – "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender", Page 72

Q6: Does believing in karma mean I have no free will?

A: No -- the book clarifies that while karma shapes much of what unfolds, we still exercise free will in how we respond, choose, and act going forward.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 6 – "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender", Page 73

Q7: How does understanding karma help us 'celebrate life'?

A: When we trust that life is unfolding fairly through cause and effect, even difficulties become easier to bear, because we stop resisting and start engaging with whatever comes with greater equanimity.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 6 – "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender", Page 74

Q8: What does it mean to 'accept life as it comes'?

A: It means meeting each situation, whether favourable or difficult, without excessive resistance, recognizing that fighting reality only adds suffering on top of whatever has already happened.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 6 – "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender", Page 75

Q9: Why was the man in the story miserable about evil people 'getting away'?

A: His suffering came from expecting immediate, visible justice and being unable to accept that consequences may unfold according to karma's own timeline, which he could not see or control.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 6 – "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender", Page 76

Q10: Is surrender the same as giving up?

A: No, surrender in this context isn't passive resignation; it's releasing the anxious need to control outcomes while still acting purposefully and engaging fully with life.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 6 – "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender", Page 68

Q11: How can accepting things I dislike actually bring peace?

A: Resistance to reality is often what generates distress, more so than the situation itself; accepting what is, even while working to change what you can, removes that extra layer of inner conflict.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 6 – "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender", Page 75

Q12: What role does ego play in our struggle to accept and surrender?

A: The ego wants to be the one in control and resists situations that challenge its sense of mastery, making acceptance and surrender feel threatening even though they ultimately bring relief.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 6 – "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender", Page 67

Q13: How is this Commandment connected to detached attachment?

A: Accepting and surrendering is essentially detachment applied to outcomes and other people's choices -- you remain engaged with life while releasing your grip on controlling how it unfolds.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 6 – "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender", Page 68

Q14: Can acceptance help with grief or loss?

A: The book's broader framework suggests that accepting impermanence and the limits of our control can ease the suffering that comes with loss, though it still honours that loss is genuinely felt.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 6 – "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender", Page 72

Q15: What's a practical way to practice surrender in daily frustrations?

A: When you notice yourself resisting or fighting a situation you can't change, the practice is to consciously let go of the 'why' and 'should' thoughts and accept the present reality as your starting point.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 6 – "Thou Shall Accept and Surrender", Page 70

TOPIC 7: OVERCOMING MISERY

Commandment 7 — "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable"

Q1: Why does nobody escape some misery in life?

A: The book acknowledges that everyone faces setbacks, but frames misery as something we have a degree of choice over, even though unhappiness can feel automatic in difficult moments.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 7 – "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable", Page 77

Q2: Why can't everybody be a champion forever?

A: Success and status are temporary by nature; clinging to the idea of permanent victory sets us up for disappointment when circumstances inevitably shift.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 7 – "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable", Page 79

Q3: What does 'we can take nothing with us' have to do with misery?

A: Remembering that none of our possessions accompany us beyond this life helps loosen the possessiveness that turns ordinary attachment into deep misery when we eventually have to let go.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 7 – "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable", Page 80

Q4: Is it wrong to enjoy possessions and relationships?

A: No -- the book distinguishes enjoying things from becoming possessive of them; enjoyment is fine, but possessiveness is what opens the door to misery.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 7 – "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable", Page 81

Q5: Why is life compared to a show or a play in this teaching?

A: Comparing life to a show reminds us that everything, including our own role in it, eventually ends, encouraging us to fully experience each 'scene' rather than dreading its conclusion.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 7 – "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable", Page 82

Q6: How does realizing 'everything is an illusion' reduce suffering?

A: Recognizing that much of what feels permanent and solid -- our roles, identities, and circumstances -- is actually fleeting, like a dream, helps us hold onto it more lightly and suffer less when it changes.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 7 – "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable", Page 83

Q7: What is the 'triple suffering' mentioned in the book?

A: It refers to suffering across body, mind, and ego -- physical pain, emotional misery, and the ego's distress -- which together make up the layered nature of human unhappiness.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 7 – "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable", Page 84

Q8: Why do we fear death so much if it's a natural part of life?

A: The book suggests our identification with the body, rather than recognizing ourselves as an enduring Soul, is what generates fear around death, since we mistake the end of the body for the end of ourselves.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 7 – "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable", Page 85

Q9: How do emotions like hate and jealousy connect to misery?

A: These toxic emotions are described as arising directly from attachment; if we were truly detached, the book argues, such emotions would have no foothold in our experience.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 7 – "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable", Page 86

Q10: Can I resolve to simply not be miserable, even in hard times?

A: The book frames this as an active resolution rather than wishful thinking -- a conscious commitment to not letting circumstances dictate our inner state, paired with the detachment practices taught elsewhere in the book.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 7 – "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable", Page 78

Q11: Why do we take small setbacks so personally?

A: Attachment to a particular self-image or outcome means even minor disruptions feel like threats to our identity or plans, amplifying ordinary setbacks into significant misery.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 7 – "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable", Page 81

Q12: How does 'letting go before we go' help reduce suffering?

A: Practicing letting go of attachments during life, rather than being forced to release everything only at death, gradually reduces the grip those attachments hold, easing suffering well before any final loss.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 7 – "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable", Page 80

Q13: Is misery inevitable, or can it really be avoided?

A: The book takes the position that misery is largely a product of attachment and resistance, both of which can be unlearned through the detached attachment practices it teaches, making misery far from inevitable.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 7 – "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable", Page 77

Q14: How does accepting impermanence change how I face loss?

A: When we expect change and accept impermanence as the natural order, the shock and resistance that typically deepen the pain of loss are reduced.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 7 – "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable", Page 83

Q15: What's the connection between ego and misery?

A: The ego's investment in being right, being in control, or maintaining a certain image is a frequent source of suffering, since reality regularly fails to cooperate with the ego's demands.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 7 – "Thou Shall Not Be Miserable", Page 84

TOPIC 8: OVERCOMING IGNORANCE

Commandment 8 — "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance"

Q1: What kind of ignorance is this Commandment talking about?

A: It's not about a lack of book knowledge, but about being unaware of deeper truths -- about the nature of the self, attachment, impermanence, and the Divine -- often because we've simply followed the crowd without question.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 8 – "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance", Page 87

Q2: Why does the book say most people 'follow the herd'?

A: Many beliefs and habits are absorbed from family or culture without ever being examined, which the book describes as a kind of unconscious conformity that perpetuates ignorance.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 8 – "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance", Page 88

Q3: Should I question everything I've been taught?

A: The book encourages using your intellect to examine inherited beliefs, superstitions, and rituals rather than accepting them automatically just because others follow them.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 8 – "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance", Page 90

Q4: Why is it hard to accept that we believe in 'myths' about life and death?

A: We're conditioned from childhood to accept certain narratives about identity, ownership, and permanence as obvious truths, making it uncomfortable to question or 'unlearn' them later.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 8 – "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance", Page 91

Q5: Why do we think possessions and relationships truly 'belong' to us?

A: Legal documents and social convention reinforce the idea of permanent ownership, but the book argues this is itself a form of ignorance, since nothing accompanies us beyond this life.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 8 – "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance", Page 92

Q6: Can a person be very old and still not have overcome ignorance?

A: Yes -- the book notes that age alone doesn't guarantee wisdom; some people live into their eighties or nineties while still deeply attached and unaware of the deeper truths the book describes.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 8 – "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance", Page 93

Q7: Do I need a Guru to overcome ignorance?

A: The book suggests a Guru can help guide the process, but those without one can still use their own intellect, though the mind's tricky nature means this path may take more discernment.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 8 – "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance", Page 94

Q8: Is it natural to be attached to people and things even without 'full' realization?

A: Yes, the book acknowledges that some attachment to loved ones and favourite things is a natural part of being human before deeper realization is reached.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 8 – "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance", Page 95

Q9: What does the story of the prince who fell in love teach about ignorance and attachment?

A: The prince's situation, involving a difficult truth that needed to be revealed to him with care, illustrates how attachment can blind us to realities that are ultimately better faced and accepted.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 8 – "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance", Page 96

Q10: How did the prince find liberation from his attachments?

A: A moment of clarity helped him realize that his wealth and relationships would not accompany him forever, and this realization itself became the turning point that freed him from his attachment.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 8 – "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance", Page 98

Q11: Why does overcoming ignorance matter for living with detachment?

A: Without recognizing the deeper truths about impermanence and the self, detachment remains only a surface-level idea rather than something genuinely understood and lived; ignorance is what keeps attachment firmly in place.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 8 – "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance", Page 87

Q12: How can I start questioning inherited beliefs without dismissing everything?

A: The book's approach isn't to reject everything wholesale, but to use discernment, keeping what holds up to honest reflection and letting go of what turns out to be unexamined assumption or superstition.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 8 – "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance", Page 90

Q13: What's the connection between ignorance and fear of death?

A: Not understanding our true nature as an enduring Soul, rather than just the body, is identified as a root cause of our fear around death and the unknown.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 8 – "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance", Page 89

Q14: Why does the book emphasize using intellect over blind belief?

A: Intellect is positioned as the tool that helps us discern truth from myth, allowing us to move past inherited assumptions toward genuine understanding rather than passive acceptance.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 8 – "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance", Page 90

Q15: Can overcoming ignorance happen gradually, or does it require a sudden realization?

A: The book suggests both paths are possible -- some experience sudden flashes of clarity, like the prince in the story, while others gradually unlearn ignorance through ongoing reflection and practice.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 8 – "Thou Shall Overcome Ignorance", Page 98

TOPIC 9: LIVING WITH PURPOSE

Commandment 9 — "Thou Shall Live with Purpose"

Q1: What does it mean to 'not waste my human birth'?

A: It means not spending an entire lifetime merely chasing pleasures and possessions without ever turning attention toward deeper questions of meaning, self-realization, and purpose.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 9 — "Thou Shall Live with Purpose", Page 99

Q2: Why isn't chasing money, fame, and possessions a worthwhile purpose?

A: The book argues these external pursuits, however exciting in the moment, don't belong to us permanently and ultimately leave us still searching, rather than fulfilled.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 9 — "Thou Shall Live with Purpose", Page 101

Q3: What is the 'triple suffering' people experience by avoiding purpose?

A: Those who only chase fun and achievement without deeper reflection are described as eventually experiencing the pain of the body, the misery of the mind, and the agony of the ego -- the layered suffering the book associates with an unexamined life.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 9 — "Thou Shall Live with Purpose", Page 102

Q4: How do I figure out my true life purpose?

A: The book frames the search for purpose as connected to discovering the truth about the self, about life, and about the Divine -- rather than something separate from the spiritual journey it outlines throughout.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 9 — "Thou Shall Live with Purpose", Page 103

Q5: Why is letting go of people and things necessary for a purposeful life?

A: Holding tightly to people and possessions can anchor us to old patterns and distract from deeper growth; releasing that grip frees energy and attention for our higher purpose.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 9 — "Thou Shall Live with Purpose", Page 103

Q6: Can small addictions really stop me from finding my purpose?

A: Yes -- the book notes that even minor addictions can quietly imprison us, consuming our attention and stalling our progress on a meaningful life journey.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 9 — "Thou Shall Live with Purpose", Page 104

Q7: What happens if I never transform or find purpose in this life?

A: The book describes this outcome as merely 'crawling through life' without truly transforming, missing out on a deeper experience of becoming one with the Divine.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 9 – "Thou Shall Live with Purpose", Page 103

Q8: Is having a career goal the same as having a life purpose?

A: Not necessarily. The book distinguishes worldly achievement and ambition from a deeper, spiritual purpose centered on self-realization and connection with the Divine, suggesting the two can coexist but aren't the same thing.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 9 – "Thou Shall Live with Purpose", Page 100

Q9: How does detachment support living with purpose?

A: Letting go of excessive attachment to outcomes and possessions, as the book teaches throughout, frees up the focus and energy needed to pursue a deeper sense of purpose rather than getting consumed by daily attachments.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 9 – "Thou Shall Live with Purpose", Page 103

Q10: What's the danger of just having fun until life is done?

A: The book warns that an approach focused purely on amusement, without reflection, leads to the very suffering -- physical, mental, and ego-related -- that the book is trying to help readers avoid.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 9 – "Thou Shall Live with Purpose", Page 102

Q11: Why does the book connect human birth to a special opportunity?

A: Human life is framed as a unique chance to wake up to deeper truths and pursue realization, a chance the book suggests shouldn't be squandered purely on superficial pursuits.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 9 – "Thou Shall Live with Purpose", Page 99

Q12: Can I pursue purpose while still enjoying everyday pleasures?

A: The book's broader teaching of detached attachment implies yes -- you can enjoy life's pleasures while keeping your ultimate focus on deeper purpose, rather than treating pleasure itself as the goal.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 9 – "Thou Shall Live with Purpose", Page 101

Q13: How do I know if I'm avoiding my real purpose?

A: If your life centers entirely on pursuing pleasure, possessions, or status without any reflection on meaning or self-realization, the book would suggest you may be sidestepping the deeper purpose it describes.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 9 – "Thou Shall Live with Purpose", Page 102

Q14: What role does self-realization play in purpose?

A: The book ties true purpose directly to realizing the truth about the self -- recognizing our deeper nature beyond the body and mind -- making self-realization central rather than incidental to a purposeful life.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 9 – "Thou Shall Live with Purpose", Page 103

Q15: Why might someone feel unfulfilled despite achieving many goals?

A: If those achievements were pursued without connecting to a deeper purpose, the book suggests the person may still feel a lingering emptiness, since worldly success alone doesn't satisfy the deeper longing for meaning.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 9 – "Thou Shall Live with Purpose", Page 105

TOPIC 10: THE DIVINE SOUL

Commandment 10 — "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul"

Q1: What does it mean to live as the 'Divine Soul'?

A: It means recognizing your true identity as a spark of Divine energy rather than the body, mind, or ego, and progressively living from that deeper awareness rather than from surface-level identifications.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 10 – "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul", Page 106

Q2: Why is this called the 'final' Commandment?

A: It represents the culmination of the journey -- transcending the body's senses, the mind's wandering, and the ego's dominance -- that the previous nine Commandments have been building toward.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 10 – "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul", Page 107

Q3: How did the body's organs form around the Soul, according to this teaching?

A: The book describes the Soul as a spark of energy present at conception, with the body's organs -- heart, brain, lungs, kidneys -- forming around this Soul as the vehicle it would inhabit.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 10 – "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul", Page 108

Q4: Why do we say 'my name is John' instead of 'I am John'?

A: The book uses this phrasing to highlight that our name, nationality, and religion belong to the body and its identity, not to the Soul itself, which transcends all these temporary labels.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 10 – "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul", Page 109

Q5: How can I actually live as the Divine Soul day to day?

A: It starts with recognizing that the body is just a temporary garment that changes over time, and gradually identifying less with that garment and more with the unchanging awareness underneath.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 10 – "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul", Page 110

Q6: Why does the Soul have no attachment?

A: The book compares the Soul to a wave that is part of the ocean -- inherently connected to the Divine whole, and therefore naturally free of the grasping and clinging that the limited ego experiences.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 10 – "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul", Page 111

Q7: What happens if I don't realize I am the Divine Soul?

A: Without this realization, the book warns we remain caught in fear, worry, and misery tied to our attachments for people and possessions, since we're identifying with the limited self instead of the boundless Soul.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 10 – "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul", Page 112

Q8: Is the Soul different for each person, or is it part of something larger?

A: The book frames the Soul as part of the Divine, much like individual waves are part of one ocean -- distinct in form but ultimately unified with a larger, shared source.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 10 – "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul", Page 111

Q9: How does living as the Soul relate to detachment from the body?

A: Recognizing the body as a temporary garment, rather than your true identity, naturally reduces over-identification with bodily pleasures, pains, and eventual decline, supporting the detachment the whole book builds toward.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 10 – "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul", Page 110

Q10: Why does the book emphasize the mind and ego as obstacles to this realization?

A: Both the wandering mind and the assertive ego tend to keep our attention locked on transient concerns and self-image, obscuring the deeper, stiller awareness of the Soul that this Commandment points toward.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 10 – "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul", Page 107

Q11: Can living as the Divine Soul coexist with everyday responsibilities?

A: Yes -- the teaching doesn't ask us to abandon daily life, but to hold our roles and responsibilities more lightly, performing them fully while remembering our deeper identity beneath the body, mind, and ego.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 10 – "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul", Page 110

Q12: How does this final Commandment tie together the previous nine?

A: Freedom, happiness, love, releasing expectations, peace of mind, acceptance, avoiding misery, overcoming ignorance, and purpose are all described as steps that gradually lead toward this ultimate realization of the Divine Soul.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 10 – "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul", Page 107

Q13: What is the 'Ultimate Goal' the book refers to in this section?

A: The Ultimate Goal is letting go of identification with body, mind, and ego entirely, and living instead from the awareness of the Soul, which the book considers the true purpose of human life.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 10 – "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul", Page 106

Q14: Why is the Soul described as immortal while the body is not?

A: Since the Soul is framed as a spark of the eternal Divine, it isn't subject to the birth and death that the temporary body experiences, giving it a continuity beyond any one lifetime.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 10 – "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul", Page 112

Q15: What's the ultimate benefit of realizing I am the Divine Soul?

A: This realization is presented as the doorway to lasting freedom from fear, attachment, and misery, since it shifts your core identity from something temporary and limited to something boundless and secure.

Source: The 10 Commandments of Detached Attachment, Commandment 10 – "Thou Shall Live as the Divine Soul", Page 112
